

RAYMOND MORGAN

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Department of Economics
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Education

Toronto Metropolitan University

Ph.D. Economics, expected 2027
B.Com. Economics, 2019

Wilfrid Laurier University

M.Sc. Mathematics (coursework), 2022
M.A. Economics, 2021

Research Interests References

Applied Microeconomics, Food Security, Indigenous and Northern Economics

Nicholas Li
Department of Economics
Toronto Metropolitan University
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Obeid Ur Rehman
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Vandna Sinha
Department of Education
University of Colorado Boulder
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Amjad Rabi
International Policy & Governance
Wilfrid Laurier University
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Doosoo Kim
Department of Economics
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Angela Doku
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Fellowships, Awards & Grants

SSHRC Insight Development Grant, 2026
The Arctic Children and Youth Foundation, Grant, 2026
Nunavut Tunngavik Inc Grant, 2026
Toronto Metropolitan University Graduate Fellowship, 2022–2026
SSHRC Insight Development Grant, 2025
Toronto Metropolitan University Graduate Development Award, 2024–2025
Wilfrid Laurier University Graduate Scholarship, 2021–2022
Wilfrid Laurier University Top MRP, 2021
John & Ann Weir Economics Scholarship, 2021
Ryerson University Community Builder Award, 2016
Ryerson University Leadership Award, 2015
Royal Canadian Navy Bravo Zulu, 2012

Teaching

Toronto Metropolitan University

Teaching/Academic Assistant for: Principles of Microeconomics, Introductory/Intermediate Macroeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics II, Statistics for Economics II, International Trade I, Advanced Topics in International Trade, Economic Development, Labour Economics, Econometrics II, 2022–Present

Wilfrid Laurier University

Teaching Assistant for: Applied Econometrics, Macroeconomic Analysis, Statistical Methods for Life and Health Science, Advanced Calculus, Introduction to Mathematical Proofs, Calculus II, 2020–2022

Research & Other Employment

Senior Research Assistant, Toronto Metropolitan University, for Nicholas Li, 2022–Present
Research Assistant, Colorado University, for Vandna Sinha, 2026
Research Assistant, Toronto Metropolitan University, for Obeid Ur Rehman, 2025–2026
Research Assistant, Toronto Metropolitan University, for Jessica Penney, 2025
Investment Associate, Royal Bank of Canada, 2019–2020
Investment Specialist, Bank of Montreal, 2017–2019
Financial Advisor, Bank of Nova Scotia, 2015–2017
Leading Seaman, Royal Canadian Navy, 2010–2015

Job Market Paper

Vertical Integration in Uncompetitive Markets: Evidence from the acquisition of North Star Air by the North West Company (with Nicholas Li)

Canada’s remote northern communities have some of the highest food prices and food insecurity rates in the world and rely on a small number of retail and transportation firms. In 2017, the largest retailer in the region, the NorthWest Company, acquired a regional airline and started transporting its own air freight to some of the “fly-in” communities it serves. Using a difference-in-difference design, we evaluate the effects of vertical integration on prices and shipment quantities of perishable foods. We find that after the acquisition, communities with vertically integrated retail-air freight experienced 3.8% lower prices and 11.9% higher shipment quantities relative to comparison communities. Effects are qualitatively similar in communities where the acquisition changed firm boundaries without changing routes or upstream competition (Ontario) versus communities where it created new routes and competition (Manitoba and Nunavut). In communities where the retailer has a larger market share, its price falls by less but total community-level shipments rise by more. A theoretical model suggests that this could be due to greater “business-stealing” and lower share of sales exposed to marginal cost reductions in more competitive communities, and evidence from retailer-level shipments supports this interpretation. Our findings show that vertical integration can benefit consumers in markets with limited competition but that the size and nature of these benefits is sensitive to upstream and downstream market structure.

Working Papers

The Costs of Extreme Remoteness (with Nicholas Li)

We examine how well available measures of remoteness capture differences in food costs, freight costs, and other welfare-relevant outcomes across remote communities in Canada. Our analysis combines the Statistics Canada Remoteness Index with several independent measures of spatial costs. These include the Federal Isolated Posts Allowance Index and Living Cost Differential, territorial community price indexes, Nutrition North Canada Revised Northern Food Basket prices, and, where possible, commercial air freight rates and online retailer shipping costs. We also examine how community size and specific transportation characteristics, including road, rail, fly-in, and seasonal surface access, interact with remoteness. Further, we examine whether the organization and scale of retail and distribution systems affect costs independently of community population. These comparisons allow us to assess whether communities that appear similarly remote according to a gravity-based measure actually face similar costs, and whether alternative spatial price and transportation measures provide additional information about the economically relevant dimensions of remoteness.

How Foreign Investment Shapes Conflict: Evidence from Myanmar

How does foreign investment shape violence in fragile states? I study this question in Myanmar, where foreign capital expanded during a decade marked by political transition, armed conflict, and the 2021 military coup. I combine a township-year panel for 2015–2024 with sectoral foreign direct investment (FDI) approvals and pre-period employment shares to construct local shift-share measures of exposure to national FDI movements. I distinguish resource from non-resource investment and disaggregate conflict fatalities by the identities of perpetrators and victims. The aggregate relationship between FDI exposure and conflict is weak, but this masks pronounced sectoral differences. Greater resource-sector exposure is associated with less state–nonstate battlefield violence but more violence by non-state actors against civilians. By contrast, greater non-resource exposure is associated with lower fatalities overall, with the largest reductions in non-state violence against civilians. These findings suggest that the consequences of foreign investment for conflict depend not simply on how much investment arrives, but on the sectors it enters and the forms of violence it reshapes.

Work in Progress

Ongoing assessment of the impact of Nutrition North Canada on Indigenous communities in Northern Ontario (with Galloway, T., Li, N., Monteith, H., Roher, S., Daley, A., Watson, B.)

Online innovation, market entry and competition in remote Indigenous communities (with Li, N., Mudathir, Y., Shirazian A.)

Policy Reports

Strengthening Food Access in Nunavut: Lessons from the Inuit Child First Initiative funded Grocery Supports and the Hamlet Food Voucher Program (with Sinha, V., Li, N., Hoang, N., Reddy, D., Darkey, J., Mitchell, K., Gilbert, S.Z., Wheatley, D., Govindapillai, S., Roher, S., Khan, M. Galloway, T.) (2026).

In this report, we document the state of food insecurity and the impact of ICFI-funded food supports for families in Nunavut. Existing research demonstrates that nearly 8 out of 10 Inuit children were food insecure before the start of the HFV, that food insecurity is linked to serious physical and psychological harm and that food insecurity in Nunavut is driven by deep structural inequities. Our research shows that Inuit families are drawing on their individual and collective strengths, and a sophisticated range of budget-stretching strategies, to try to ensure access to food, with dignity, for everyone in the community.

Measurement and analysis of food price levels and inflation in Nunavut, 2017-2025 (with Li, N., Morrison, M., Sinha, V., Wheatley, D.)(2026).

The aim of this report is to provide the most comprehensive analysis of food prices in Nunavut to date. We analyzed multiple sources of Nunavut food price data to provide a comprehensive assessment of current price levels (i.e. how the price of a product or basket of products compares to Canadian averages) and recent inflation (i.e. how much prices have increased in Nunavut compared to increases in Canadian average prices). We draw on receipts from families receiving individual grocery supports through the Inuit Child First Initiative (ICFI) that were digitized, shared with us by Indigenous Services Canada as well as publicly available data sources – the Nunavut Price Survey, published RNFB food basket costs from Nutrition North Canada, scraped prices from retailer websites, and other data sets published by Statistics Canada and the Federal Government – to analyze price inflation and price levels compared to the rest of Canada.

Preliminary findings from an evaluation of the Hamlet Food Voucher Program in Qikiqtaaluk, Nunavut: Technical report (with Galloway, T., Govindapillai, S., Hoang, N, Khan, M.N., Lavoie, J.G., Li, N., Mitchell, K., Penney, J., Reddy, D.,

Wheatley, D., Sinha, V.)(2025)

In this report, we present preliminary findings from a multidisciplinary, mixed methods study that started as an evaluation of individual requests for grocery supports in Qikiqtaaluk and evolved as the Hamlet Food Voucher programs came into place and were then discontinued. We draw on key informant interviews with 21 people living/working in seven hamlets or working at the regional level (Qikiqtaaluk or Nunavut). we draw on existing literature to briefly describe food insecurity in the Qikiqtaaluk region of Nunavut as a long-term, systemic problem. It is grounded in colonialism and compounded by a gap between the support available through government benefits (like income assistance and child benefits) and the cost of living in Nunavut.

Other Writing	Research Note for NNC on Community Eligibility (with Li, N.) (2026).
	Competition in the Food Supply Chain in Northern Canada (with Li, N.)(2026).
Invited Seminars and Conferences	Toronto Metropolitan University Economics Brown Bag Seminars, 2023–Present University of Toronto Economics Brown Bag Seminars, 2026–Present Balsillie School of International Affairs, 2026 Atlantic Canada Economics Conference, 2025 Chiefs of Ontario Wellness Conference, 2025 Inuit Food Sovereignty Conference, 2025
Service	Founder, Ryerson Student Union Mature Student Association, 2014–2016 Mentor, Tri-Mentoring Program, 2015–2016 Member, CESAR Event Planning Committee, 2015–2016 Student Representative, TRSM Student Success Committee, 2014–2015 Student Representative, TRSM Data Benchmarking Committee, 2014–2015
Skills	Stata, Python, R, L ^A T _E X, GIS